LESSON 2

Goin' Home

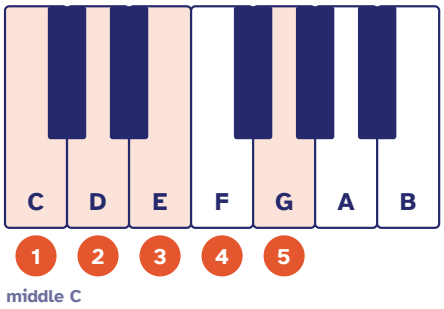
The slow tune from Dvořák's *New World* Symphony, written in 1893 while he was far from home in America. Later it was given words: a song about going home.

IN THIS SONG **the C position** **a skip: E up to G** **the semibreve** **fingers 1 2 3 5**

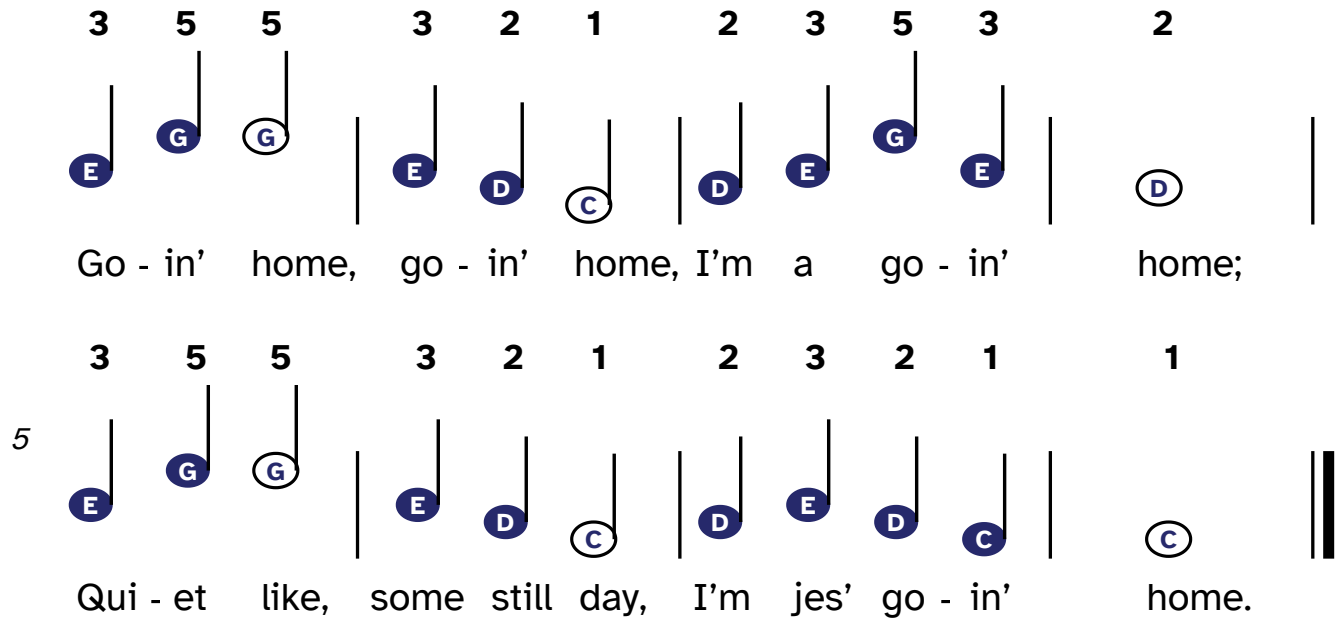
LISTEN FIRST
Scan the code: listen to the whole song once, then hum along the second time.

1 Meet the song

Listen, pointing to each note. Sing it with the words, then on the letter names.



Your hand: the C position. Thumb on middle C, one finger on each key up to G. This song uses 1, 2, 3 and 5.
The skip. E jumps up to G, right over F.



THE WOW MOMENT
☆ **Play it with the string quartet.** Scan the code, choose the quartet, and your notes ride on real strings, the way Dvořák heard them. Then stamp your **passport**: Dvořák.

☐ **Listened and pointed** ☐ **Sang it with the words** ☐ **Sang the letter names**

2 Take it apart

The same song, one piece at a time: first its rhythm, then its notes.

THE RHYTHM

Say the words in time, then clap them and count: clap on the coral numbers, hold through the grey ones.

THE BEAT

Count 1 2 3 4 in every bar: four beats a bar now.
Walk on a beat; hold a minim for two; hold a semibreve for the whole bar.

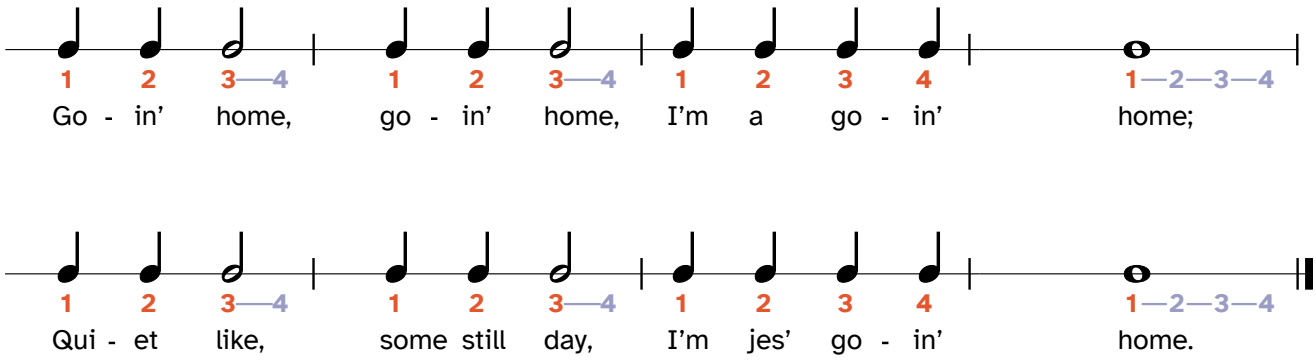
THE NOTES



crotchet: walk — 1 beat

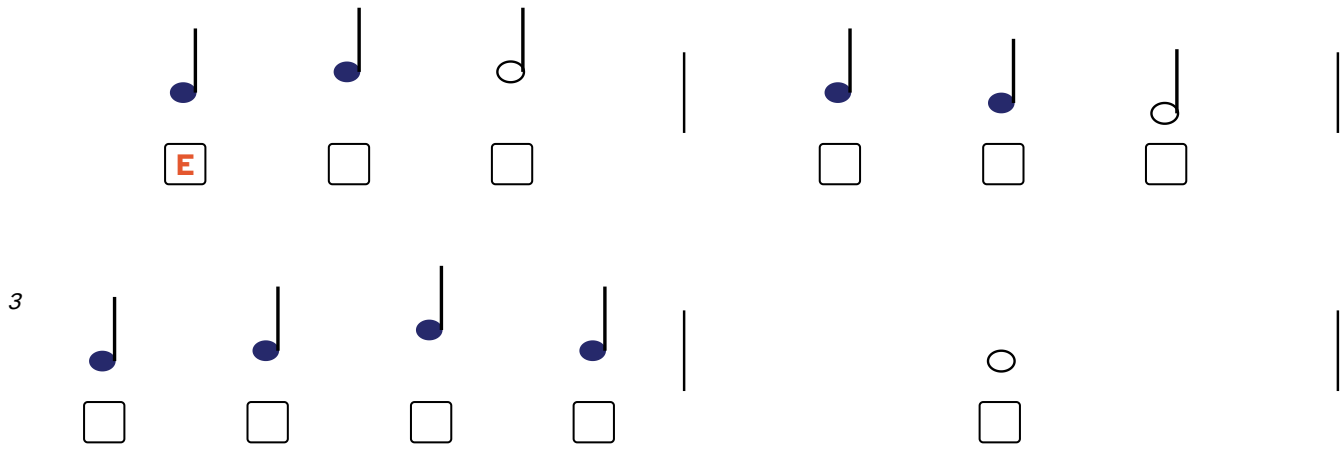
minim: hold — 2 beats

semibreve: hold-2-3-4 — 4 beats



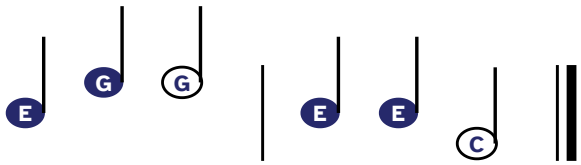
THE NOTES

Write C, D, E or G in each box of the first four bars. Then circle the skip: E straight up to G.



SPOT THE MISTAKE

One note here is wrong. Play it, then the same bars on page 1: which note sounds wrong? Circle it.



- [ ] **Said it in time**
- [ ] **Clapped and counted**
- [ ] **Wrote the letter names**
- [ ] **Found the skip**
- [ ] **Spotted the mistake**

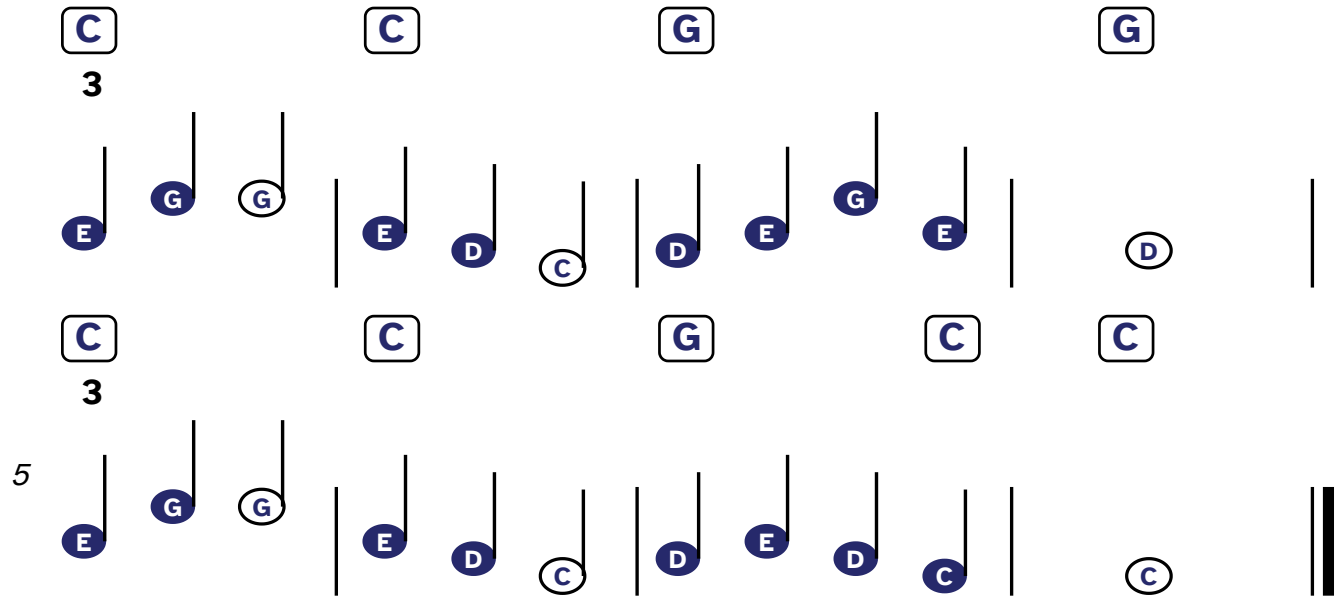
3 Lead sheet

The tune, with only the chord names above it. You play the tune; the band on the listening page plays the names.

THE NAMES

A name tells the band which chord to play under the tune. Your left hand learns to play them from Lesson 4.

C G



1 Find where the name changes

2 Play the tune with the band (the listening page): the band plays the names

3 Say the names out loud in time while the band plays

4 · CHECK

☐ I can say and clap it ☐ I can sing it with the words ☐ I can find the skip

I can play it: colour a step each time you climb

	With letters	No letters	With the band	Fast
The tune				
With the band				

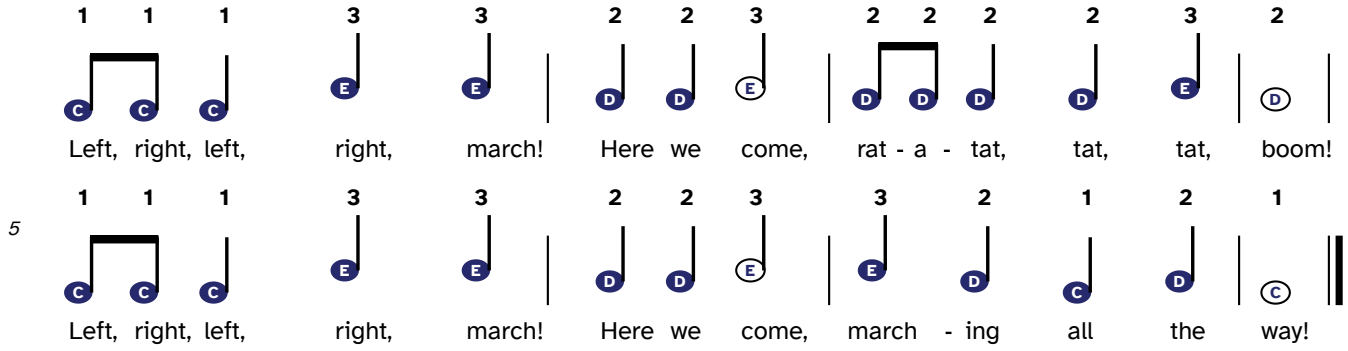
LISTEN BACK ☐ I recorded it ☐ It sounded right

+ More to play

Use what this lesson taught in new ways: a march on three keys, then a train that jumps the skip.

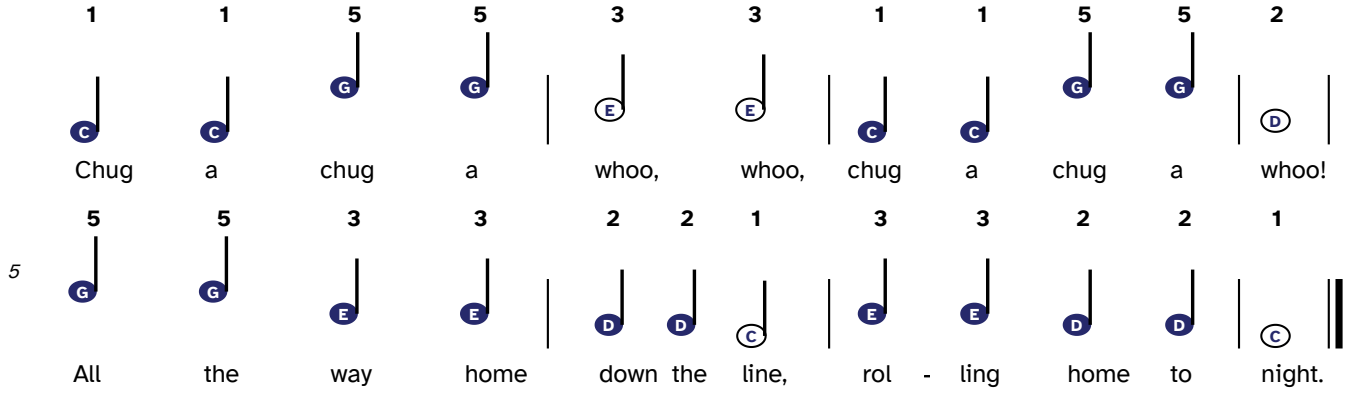
TOY SOLDIERS

A march, crisp and steady: C, D and E, a skip from C to E, and one long BOOM to hold. Sing along!



NIGHT TRAIN

A train rolling home through the dark: thumb and 5 jump C to G; the long whoo is a semibreve.



MAKE IT YOURS

Pick one and play the whole song that way. Record it on a phone and listen back: does it sound the way you meant?

- ☐ **Eyes closed: feel the skip, E up to G**
- ☐ **Sleepy: slow and soft, like evening**
- ☐ **Up high: an octave higher**

5 MINUTES AT HOME

1. Listen to the song once
2. Right hand, twice
3. Lead sheet: the tune with the band
4. Play it with the quartet

☐ M ☐ T ☐ W ☐ T ☐ F ☐ S ☐ S

☐ **Played Toy Soldiers** ☐ **Played Night Train**